rights for trade and pilgrimages between India and Tibet, as well as Indian promises to withdraw its military missions and reduce its overall footprint in Tibet. Finally, it contained the five principles of peaceful coexistence, or Panchsheel, including clauses on mutual respect for territorial integrity and noninterference in each other's internal affairs.

An NSC assessment saw the Indian desire for an accommodation with China through a cultural prism and thought it stemmed from "legendary bonds of friendship and culture" and "psychological ties arising from the fact that the Chinese as a colored race and as Asians have asserted themselves against the West."[105] But, for Nehru, there was a more important reason. While he did not think there was any "immediate likelihood," it was not inconceivable that India's relations with China would deteriorate. He told senior foreign ministry officials that there could be a new phase of Chinese expansionism in the future, and the only feasible solution for India was to "fashion our policy to prevent [China] coming in the way of our interests or other interests that we consider important." The agreement might not be "a permanent guarantee," but it was a useful insurance policy at that stage.[106] Beijing could change its mind, he acknowledged to Burmese leader U Nu, but he wanted to take advantage of that moment when it sought Delhi's friendship.[107] This approach was especially desirable for a leadership that did not want to enter an alliance to ensure the country's security. Moreover, Nehru believed that India's importance increased because of its "intimate relations" with China since Delhi could "say things [to Beijing] which many other nations could not."[108]

The Sino-Indian agreement did not help India's cause in the US. The *New York Times* declared, "Peiping Gets Indian Gift."[109] On Capitol Hill, Representative Bolton called the agreement the "first step toward the communization of India."[110] Allen tried to explain that the "favorable Indian attitude toward China is not because China is Communist, but in spite of the fact that it is Communist." He acknowledged that the agreement might not be a good deal but said Indian policymakers accepted it as "the best deal they could get."[111]

Nehru traced the criticism to lack of awareness of the bigger picture—that the agreement was an effort to "encircle and contain China in a ring of pledges," as one scholar put it.[112] Indians generally approved of it, but there were voices of dissent from China critics in the Praja Socialist Party on the